



PERFORMANCE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

British Enrolment Partners · Durham Cathedral Schools Foundation

International enrolment strategy and recruitment coordination

Prepared for Durham Cathedral Schools Foundation

Prepared by British Enrolment Partners

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1. Executive summary

British Enrolment Partners (BEP) is pleased to propose a Performance Partnership to Durham Cathedral Schools Foundation (the Foundation): an outsourced, integrated international enrolment function that recruits the right international pupils, in the markets you choose, with the accountability the work now demands.

The Foundation is already a strong proposition. Bow School, The Chorister School and Durham School together offer a co-educational day and boarding education from 3 to 18 in the heart of Durham, with more than six centuries of heritage, a cathedral connection and musical tradition few schools can claim, and recently refurbished boarding. This is not a school that needs inventing for the international market. Its strengths need translating into a more coordinated and higher-converting enrolment function.

You already enrol international boarders and have set a clear objective for the next cycle: ten more. This proposal is written to meet that target by building on what you have, rather than starting from nothing. International recruitment has outgrown the old pattern of occasional fairs, scattered agent relationships and reactive follow-up. Run well, it produces a stronger and better-balanced intake. Run in the margins of a busy week, it leans on too few agents and too few markets, and loses momentum between enquiry and enrolment.

Under this partnership, BEP would act as your international enrolment function across the markets and channels you agree. We would not replace your admissions authority or ask you to give up trusted agents. We would coordinate the whole process around your priorities: market strategy, agent management, lead generation, family liaison, application support, offer conversion and pre-arrival preparation, all aligned to pupil fit, nationality balance and long-term retention.

The route is structured to keep your upfront cost low and your interests aligned with ours. Rather than a monthly retainer, BEP proposes a 15% operation fee on fee income from new international enrolments supported through the function, for the duration of each pupil's enrolment. We earn as you do, and only while the pupils recruited through the function stay and thrive.

2. Where Durham already stands

This proposal builds on where the Foundation already is, not on starting from nothing. Durham is a genuine British boarding school with more than six centuries of heritage, a cathedral and choral tradition few can claim, recently refurbished boarding, and a name carried far beyond the North East by Old Dunelmians from Tony Blair to Rowan Atkinson and Alexander Armstrong. You already enrol international boarders, and you have set a clear, achievable objective for the next cycle: ten more.

That is exactly the brief BEP is built for. It is a defined target rather than a vague ambition, and the work is to coordinate and convert, not to manufacture demand. The priority is to develop your existing markets and agents, widen beyond a small number of source countries so the intake stays balanced, and close the gap between enquiry and enrolment where momentum is currently lost. BEP brings the in-territory presence, the wider agent network and the day-to-day coordination to turn that ten-pupil goal into a repeatable pipeline, not a one-year push.

3. What BEP would do

BEP is not offering to introduce a few students, a network membership or a parent marketplace, and we do not ask you to surrender a single agent relationship. We would run, or scaffold, your international enrolment function as one coordinated process.

In practice, BEP takes responsibility for the work between market opportunity and settled pupil: clarifying your strongest markets and pupil profiles; coordinating your existing agents and adding new ones where needed; holding in-market momentum between fairs, visits and campaigns; nurturing families from first enquiry to application and from offer to arrival; supporting conversion so accepted pupils do not drift away; making the pipeline visible by market, source and stage; and helping you recruit a more intentional, better-balanced intake.

Where BEP stops, and where you begin

Outsourcing catering is not the same as outsourcing admissions, and we would never suggest it is. The line is simple, and it is the school gate. Everything outside it, the markets, the agents, the enquiries, the follow-up, the applications and the in-territory work, is what BEP runs. Everything at it, the welcome, the personal relationship with a joining family, the connection that makes a family choose you and stay, remains with your admissions team. A school keeps its families through human connection, and that is yours to give. You keep admissions standards and decisions, scholarship and bursary calls, pastoral and boarding care, and final offer approval. BEP runs the coordination layer; you retain control of the school.

These are not separate services to choose from. They are the working parts of one function, run together:

- **Market research and recruitment strategy.** We assess your positioning, target markets, competitor context, pupil profile, nationality balance and channel priorities, then build a practical roadmap.
- **Agent coordination.** Your existing agents, and any we introduce, managed as one accountable process rather than a scatter of relationships.
- **Enrolment coordination.** Outreach, applications and follow-up connected across every pupil and every agent.
- **Family communication and liaison.** Consistent contact from first enquiry through arrival and into the year.
- **Application handling.** A structured route from enquiry to enrolment, including online entry assessment for every year group.
- **Market development.** Sustained in-territory presence in your priority regions.
- **CRM and visibility.** Your pipeline and your data, visible to you and owned by you.
- **Reporting and evidence.** A clear view of intake by market, and of the balance and fit of who you are enrolling.
- **Events and activity.** Familiarisation (fam) trips, roadshows and fairs, planned and supported rather than improvised.
- **Digital marketing.** Campaign management across the international and country-specific channels that reach your markets.

4. Commercial structure

For the Foundation, BEP proposes the **Performance Partnership**: a 15% operation fee on fee income from new international enrolments supported through the function, for the duration of each pupil's enrolment. There is no monthly retainer, no exclusivity, no requirement to replace existing agents, and no introduction-only commission. BEP is paid for operating and coordinating the function across the pupils and channels it supports.

Because Durham already recruits internationally, attribution should be defined cleanly from the outset. The fee applies to new international enrolments generated or materially progressed through the BEP function. Pupils already in your own existing pipeline at the point we begin are excluded, and the agreement will record that boundary so it is never in question.

For the agreement, we recommend defining fee income as the net tuition and boarding fee income received by the Foundation from a new international pupil enrolled through the BEP-supported function, excluding VAT, scholarships, bursaries, discounts, disbursements, refunds and bad debt. Unless expressly agreed otherwise, the operation fee would not cover paid advertising, event and exhibition fees, international travel and accommodation, translation or third-party creative, or software bought specifically for the school.

5. What this gives Durham

The Foundation has what international families look for: a credible British boarding identity, a strong pastoral culture, academic ambition, a distinctive musical and cathedral-linked heritage, and a full day and boarding experience from prep to sixth form. The question is not whether you have something worth taking to market. You do. It is whether that proposition is being taken to market in a coordinated, commercial and conversion-focused way, and whether the intake it produces is as balanced and intentional as you want over the next three to five years.

For many schools the function sits across too many desks at once: admissions, marketing, leadership and boarding. Good people do good work, but the function itself is underpowered. Agents are managed in bursts, fair follow-up depends on whoever has capacity, and families drift between enquiry and application because no one owns the middle. With BEP coordinating it, you would expect:

- **A stronger, more consistent international pipeline.**
- **Better conversion from enquiry to application, and from offer to enrolment.**
- **Clearer control over geography, profile and nationality balance.**
- **Your own team freed from the in-market grind to do the work only they can.**
- **Greater visibility of international performance, by market and by stage.**
- **A model in which BEP is rewarded for outcomes, retention and fit, not introductions.**

6. Timeline: the first twelve months

Phase	Activity
1. Audit and onboarding	Kick-off with Foundation leadership and admissions; review of current setup, markets, partners and pipeline; agreement of objectives, pupil profile and priority growth areas.
2. Strategy and activation	International roadmap finalised; priority markets and channel plan agreed; existing agent network reviewed and segmented; reporting framework confirmed.
3. Market and partner activation	Agent reactivation; new partner development in agreed markets; lead generation and family nurturing under way; in-market representation where relevant.
4. Conversion and enrolment support	Family liaison and application progression; offer follow-up and joining support; market reporting and pipeline optimisation; termly strategic review.

The first year should be judged not only on total enrolments, but on the quality of the pipeline created, the strength of the partner network, the visibility of the function, and your improved ability to recruit with intent.

7. Recommendation and next steps

Durham Cathedral Schools Foundation already has the makings of a strong international proposition: heritage, boarding, culture, academic breadth, a values-led environment, and a real international base to build on. The next step is not a new story. It is a better-functioning enrolment engine around the story you already have.

The natural first step is a no-cost, no-obligation audit of your current international setup: your coverage, your agents, your process and where pupils come from, set against the markets and pupil profile you want. It runs under an NDA, with a written undertaking not to approach or work around any agent it sees, and it includes a market and recruitment-strategy review, so you can see where the clearest opportunities lie before committing to anything. It would confirm your priority markets, preferred pupil profile and nationality balance, current channel performance and gaps, first-year objectives, and the commercial definitions for fee income and attribution. Where your setup is already strong, we will say so. From there, and only where we both see real opportunity, we agree the route and move into launch and coordination, so you enter the next recruitment cycle with an international enrolment function that is more joined up and more effective than one run in the margins of a busy week.